

LESSON 10 | KEEPING THE PASTOR’S HEART HEALTHY

***“Guard your heart above all else, for it determines the course of your life.”
Proverbs 4:23 (NLT)***

1. _____.

John 15:5 (NLT): “Yes, I am the vine; you are the branches. Those who remain in me, and I in them, will produce much fruit. For apart from me you can do nothing.”

2. _____.

Proverbs 27:17 (NLT): “As iron sharpens iron, so a friend sharpens a friend.”

3. _____.

Mark 6:31 (NLT): “Then Jesus said, ‘Let’s go off by ourselves to a quiet place and rest awhile.’ He said this because there were so many people coming and going that Jesus and his apostles didn’t even have time to eat.”

4. _____.

Hebrews 12:15 (NLT): “Look after each other so that none of you fails to receive the grace of God. Watch out that no poisonous root of bitterness grows up to trouble you, corrupting many.”

5. _____.

1 Corinthians 15:58 (NLT): “So, my dear brothers and sisters, be strong and immovable. Always work enthusiastically for the Lord, for you know that nothing you do for the Lord is ever useless

PRACTICAL APPLICATION FOR PASTORS

Book time with God like you would any important meeting.

Have trusted friends and mentors you can call.

Use your days off, vacations, and Sabbath wisely.

Don't let wounds fester.

Thank God regularly for the privilege of ministry.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1. What practices currently keep your heart healthy?**
- 2. Where are you most vulnerable to burnout or bitterness?**
- 3. How can you strengthen your personal relationship with God in this season?**
- 4. Who are the people in your life who help keep you encouraged?**

5. What's one small change you could make this week to restore joy in ministry?

ASSIGNMENT

- This week, take one intentional action for each of these five areas: time with God, relationships, rest, forgiveness, and joy.
- Share your plan with a trusted leader or friend for accountability.

CLOSING CHALLENGE

Your heart is the wellspring of your ministry. Guard it fiercely.

Howard Hendricks said, *"If you take care of the depth of your ministry, God will take care of the breadth of your ministry."* Keep your heart full, your spirit strong, and your joy alive, for your sake, for your family's sake, and for the sake of the flock entrusted to you.